ONE-PAGE BRIEF

Should we replace markdown PDFs?

Markdown exports are fast but bland. The current need is branded, reusable business PDFs without a large design toolchain.

DECISION

Yes

QUALITY

Higher

Real layout, hierarchy, and print CSS.

OPS BURDEN

Low

Python script, JSON data, source-controlled templates.

RISK

Medium

CSS support and native dependencies must be verified.

What matters

- Readable extracted text
- A4 page discipline
- Long values wrap cleanly
- No JavaScript dependency

Risks

- Unsupported CSS surprises
- Font differences across machines
- Pretty sample data hides overflow bugs

RECOMMENDED NEXT ACTION

Use WeasyPrint for owned designed PDFs; keep Playwright for JS-heavy pages.

It keeps the authoring model simple while producing substantially better PDFs than generic exports.